The IDF formed a plan to focus its forces in an initial effort to eject the Egyptians from the Negev. This area was of particular concern because Bernadotte's final proposed peace plan had suggested handing control of this area over to Egypt and Jordan. If the IDF could eject the Egyptian Army from their positions, this proposal would become much more difficult to enforce.

The only other Arab army that could be used to support the Egyptians was the Arab Legion, but many senior members of the Israeli government believed that King Abdullah would not permit this, preferring to see his main rival for control of Palestine humiliated on the battlefield. On October 15, the IDF launched Operation Yoav, the first of a series of operations intended to drive Egyptian forces out of the Negev. The second truce was over, and the third phase of the war was about to begin.